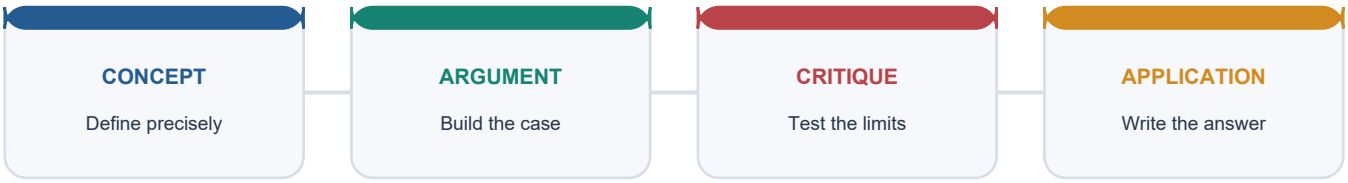
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Jahangir & the Early Seventeenth Century (Nur Jahan) - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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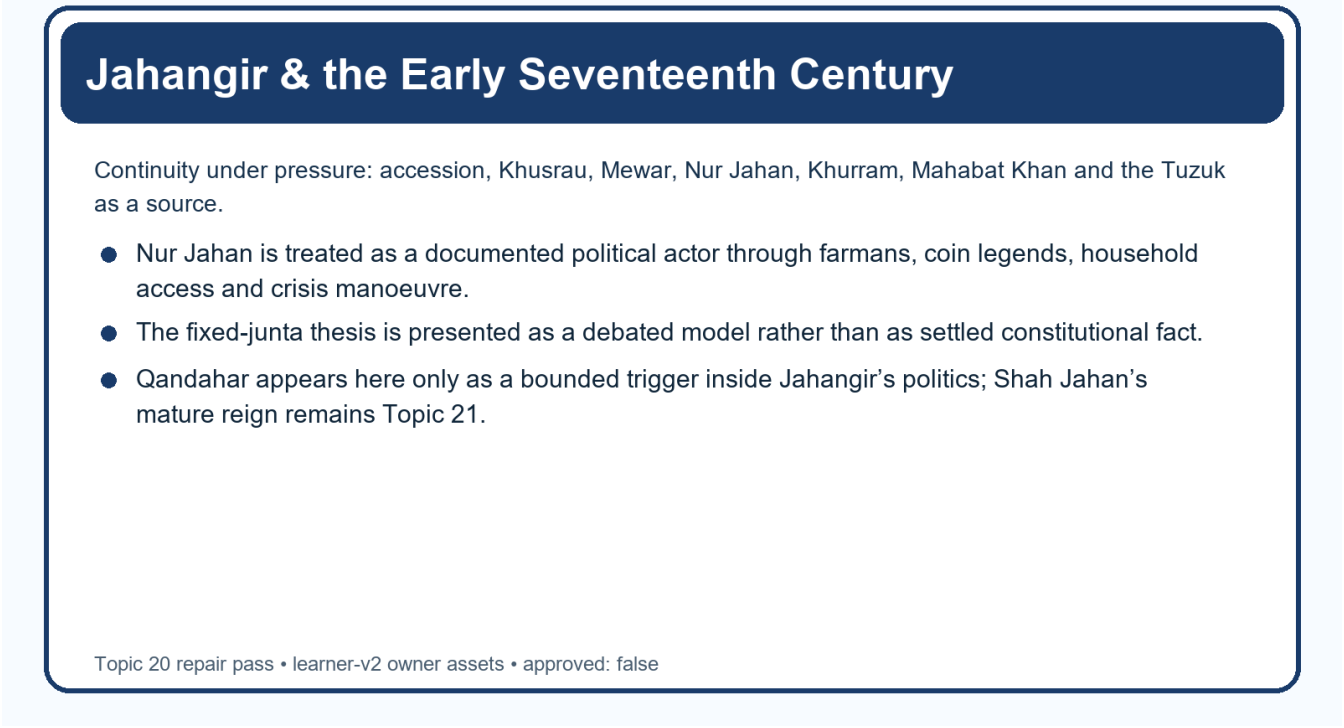
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Jahangir & the Early Seventeenth Century (Nur Jahan) - Solved Practice Workbook



Topic 20 cover

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Part I - 32 workbook MCQs with full option-wise explanations

Workbook MCQ 1

Question: Why must Jahangir's accession be described as a political settlement rather than a routine hereditary transfer?

- A. Because Salim's Allahabad autonomy, damaged trust and need for noble recognition made accession an active bargain.
- B. Because the Mughal empire had abolished dynastic succession entirely by 1605.
- C. Because European ambassadors elected the new emperor.
- D. Because Jahangir first became emperor only after Mahabat Khan's coup.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Because Salim's Allahabad autonomy, damaged trust and need for noble recognition made accession an active bargain.** - Correct. The accession followed Salim's semi-autonomous Allahabad phase and required noble recognition, offices and public justice language to convert claim into accepted sovereignty.
- **B. Because the Mughal empire had abolished dynastic succession entirely by 1605.** - Incorrect. Dynastic succession had not vanished; the point is that dynastic right still needed political settlement inside the Mughal elite order.
- **C. Because European ambassadors elected the new emperor.** - Incorrect. European envoys were marginal to the 1605 succession; the decisive arena was Mughal dynastic and noble politics.
- **D. Because Jahangir first became emperor only after Mahabat Khan's coup.** - Incorrect. Mahabat Khan's coup belongs to 1626 and tested a long-established reign; it did not create Jahangir's accession.

Examiner trap: Pre-accession tension turned into a false claim that hereditary right had disappeared altogether.

Workbook MCQ 2

Question: Which statement most accurately describes the evidentiary value of Jahangir's twelve orders?

- A. They prove every district obeyed the same code in the same way.
- B. They most securely reveal the emperor's proclaimed programme of regulation and justice.
- C. They replace the need for any corroborating source.
- D. They are later folklore with no connection to Jahangir's memoir at all.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. They prove every district obeyed the same code in the same way.** - Incorrect. Uniform local enforcement is precisely the claim the memoir cannot prove on its own.
- **B. They most securely reveal the emperor's proclaimed programme of regulation and justice.** - Correct. The orders are strongest as evidence of what Jahangir chose to publicise about early rule and royal rectitude.
- **C. They replace the need for any corroborating source.** - Incorrect. Royal memoirs need corroboration because proclamation and implementation are not identical historical levels.
- **D. They are later folklore with no connection to Jahangir's memoir at all.** - Incorrect. However later lists may vary, the *Jahangirnama* certainly preserves a Jahangiri regulatory programme.

Examiner trap: Proclamation was mistaken for verified empire-wide implementation.

Workbook MCQ 3

Question: The zanjir-i-adl is most safely interpreted as

- A. a Mughal parliament of petitioners.
- B. a permanent record of equal judicial remedies.
- C. a ruler-centred symbol and possible route of direct petition.
- D. proof that local officials no longer mattered in Mughal governance.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. a Mughal parliament of petitioners.** - Incorrect. The chain did not create a representative institution; it dramatised the emperor's accessibility.
- **B. a permanent record of equal judicial remedies.** - Incorrect. A symbolic chain cannot by itself document equal outcomes across the empire.
- **C. a ruler-centred symbol and possible route of direct petition.** - Correct. It projected the image of a sovereign who could be directly approached and who embodied corrective justice.
- **D. proof that local officials no longer mattered in Mughal governance.** - Incorrect. Officials still mattered greatly; the chain did not erase the administrative hierarchy below the emperor.

Examiner trap: A sovereign symbol was inflated into a full constitutional judicial system.

Workbook MCQ 4

Question: Why is the Muqarrab Khan-related justice case useful but limited evidence?

- A. It shows Jahangir had no interest in punishment at all.
- B. It proves all governors feared equal legal sanctions every day.
- C. It belongs only to Shah Jahan's reign.
- D. It illustrates an imperial intervention without proving uniformly realised justice across the realm.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. It shows Jahangir had no interest in punishment at all.** - Incorrect. The episode is cited precisely because punitive intervention did occur.

- **B. It proves all governors feared equal legal sanctions every day.** - Incorrect. One exemplary punishment cannot be expanded into a guarantee of equal and constant justice everywhere.
- **C. It belongs only to Shah Jahan's reign.** - Incorrect. Satish Chandra places the case in Jahangir's reign as part of the justice discussion.
- **D. It illustrates an imperial intervention without proving uniformly realised justice across the realm.** - Correct. It is valuable as a concrete illustration of rulerly intervention, but it cannot by itself settle empire-wide implementation.

Examiner trap: A single vivid case was treated as if it automatically described the whole empire.

Workbook MCQ 5

Question: What made Lahore and the Punjab corridor so important in Khusrau's revolt?

- A. The rebel's movement, possible support networks and the north-west route gave the revolt political geography.
- B. They were the English Company's first territorial possession in India.
- C. They were identical with the Deccan war zone of Malik Ambar.
- D. They mattered only because Jahangir's tomb was already there in 1606.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. The rebel's movement, possible support networks and the north-west route gave the revolt political geography.** - Correct. Punjab mattered because succession challenge travelled through routes, supporters and an important frontier-urban field centred on Lahore.
- **B. They were the English Company's first territorial possession in India.** - Incorrect. English territorial possession is anachronistic here and unrelated to Khusrau's movement.
- **C. They were identical with the Deccan war zone of Malik Ambar.** - Incorrect. Malik Ambar belongs to the Deccan context, not to the Punjab succession corridor of 1606.
- **D. They mattered only because Jahangir's tomb was already there in 1606.** - Incorrect. Jahangir's later burial association with Lahore should not be projected backward as the reason the revolt mattered.

Examiner trap: Later associations with Lahore replaced the 1606 political geography of the revolt.

Workbook MCQ 6

Question: Which statement best captures the historiographical caution required in the Guru Arjan episode?

- A. Jahangir's memoir alone settles every motive and consequence.
- B. Politics after Khusrau, imperial religious language and Sikh memory all need to be held together.
- C. The event has no relevance for later Mughal-Sikh relations.
- D. Only later Sikh memory matters; the court record can be discarded.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Jahangir's memoir alone settles every motive and consequence.** - Incorrect. The court record is indispensable but not sufficient as a total explanation.
- **B. Politics after Khusrau, imperial religious language and Sikh memory all need to be held together.** - Correct. A layered answer has to keep political suspicion, religious language and later community memory in the same frame.
- **C. The event has no relevance for later Mughal-Sikh relations.** - Incorrect. The event is widely treated as a turning point, even though later militarisation followed a longer chronology.
- **D. Only later Sikh memory matters; the court record can be discarded.** - Incorrect. Discarding the court source is as mistaken as absolutising it.

Examiner trap: One evidentiary lane was used to cancel all the others.

Workbook MCQ 7

Question: Which term best describes the 1615 Mewar outcome?

- A. complete equality between two sovereigns.
- B. direct provincial annexation.
- C. Mughal suzerainty combined with honour-sensitive accommodation.
- D. religiously motivated extermination of the Sisodia line.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. complete equality between two sovereigns.** - Incorrect. Mughal superiority remained clear; the compact was not one of equal sovereign standing.
- **B. direct provincial annexation.** - Incorrect. The Rana house remained in place, which is exactly why annexation is the wrong word.
- **C. Mughal suzerainty combined with honour-sensitive accommodation.** - Correct. Submission occurred, but it was structured so that Sisodia prestige could survive publicly.
- **D. religiously motivated extermination of the Sisodia line.** - Incorrect. The settlement integrated rather than eliminated the ruling house.

Examiner trap: Because force preceded settlement, the settlement itself was mislabeled as annexation.

Workbook MCQ 8

Question: Karan Singh's reception at the Mughal court is most useful as evidence for

- A. the abolition of Mughal hierarchy in Rajput relations.
- B. the transfer of Mewar to English protection.
- C. Rana Amar Singh's personal annual attendance obligation.
- D. the integration of a Sisodia prince into service while preserving the Rana's honour.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. the abolition of Mughal hierarchy in Rajput relations.** - Incorrect. Honourable incorporation worked within Mughal hierarchy rather than dissolving it.
- **B. the transfer of Mewar to English protection.** - Incorrect. The English had no role in the Mewar settlement structure.
- **C. Rana Amar Singh's personal annual attendance obligation.** - Incorrect. One of the settlement's distinctive features was that the Rana himself was not forced into personal attendance.
- **D. the integration of a Sisodia prince into service while preserving the Rana's honour.** - Correct. Karan Singh's honourable reception demonstrates how subordination could be made politically acceptable.

Examiner trap: The son's service obligation was confused with the father's personal attendance.

Workbook MCQ 9

Question: What is the safest broad statement about Jahangir's Bengal policy?

- A. Islam Khan used Dacca, campaigns and later conciliation to extend Mughal consolidation eastward.
- B. All of Bengal and Assam were permanently pacified in a single campaign.
- C. The region mattered only for European trade and not for provincial reorganisation.
- D. No Afghan elements entered Mughal service after eastern campaigns.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Islam Khan used Dacca, campaigns and later conciliation to extend Mughal consolidation eastward.** - Correct. The combination of headquarters shift, campaign and selective restoration captures the actual pattern of consolidation.
- **B. All of Bengal and Assam were permanently pacified in a single campaign.** - Incorrect. The eastern field remained uneven; the Ahom attack failed and one-date totalisation is inaccurate.

- **C. The region mattered only for European trade and not for provincial reorganisation.** - Incorrect. Provincial headquarters, zamindar politics and campaign management were central, not incidental.
- **D. No Afghan elements entered Mughal service after eastern campaigns.** - Incorrect. One important point of the topic is that more Afghans were incorporated into the Mughal nobility.

Examiner trap: An extended eastern process was compressed into one conquest date.

Workbook MCQ 10

Question: Why is the 1620 capture of Kangra historically important in Topic 20?

- A. It marks Jahangir's recovery of Qandahar from the Safavids.
- B. It shows a fort-level strategic and symbolic success in the Himalayan field.
- C. It proves uniform Mughal administration over every hill polity.
- D. It ended all Deccan warfare with Malik Ambar.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. It marks Jahangir's recovery of Qandahar from the Safavids.** - Incorrect. Qandahar belongs to the north-western foreign-policy question, not to Kangra.
- **B. It shows a fort-level strategic and symbolic success in the Himalayan field.** - Correct. Kangra mattered as a strategically difficult fort whose capture also allowed ritual display of sovereignty.
- **C. It proves uniform Mughal administration over every hill polity.** - Incorrect. A single stronghold cannot certify effortless control over the whole Himalayan political landscape.
- **D. It ended all Deccan warfare with Malik Ambar.** - Incorrect. Deccan conflict persisted and is analytically separate from the Kangra success.

Examiner trap: A fort conquest was overextended into a claim of total regional mastery.

Workbook MCQ 11

Question: What did the English naval success at Swally/Suvali in 1612 chiefly change?

- A. It converted the Company into a territorial sovereign in western India.
- B. It abolished Mughal control over Surat customs.
- C. It improved English bargaining position against the Portuguese in the Gujarat maritime setting.
- D. It forced Jahangir to abandon diplomacy with Europeans altogether.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. It converted the Company into a territorial sovereign in western India.** - Incorrect. Maritime success strengthened bargaining but did not create a land-based English state.
- **B. It abolished Mughal control over Surat customs.** - Incorrect. Mughal sovereignty over Surat and its customs regime continued.
- **C. It improved English bargaining position against the Portuguese in the Gujarat maritime setting.** - Correct. Swally mattered because it weakened Portuguese leverage and helped the English negotiate from a less vulnerable position.
- **D. It forced Jahangir to abandon diplomacy with Europeans altogether.** - Incorrect. Jahangir continued engaging Europeans; the issue was the terms of access, not diplomatic abandonment.

Examiner trap: Naval success at sea was mistaken for immediate political sovereignty on land.

Workbook MCQ 12

Question: Which statement about Roe's 1618 commercial permissions is NOT defensible?

- A. They should be read with local practice and factory records.
- B. They confirmed limited trading access on Mughal terms.
- C. They did not amount to territory or empire-wide monopoly.

- D. They granted the English a sovereign territorial state in India.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. They should be read with local practice and factory records.** - Incorrect. This is exactly the cautious way to use a farman-based trading privilege.
- **B. They confirmed limited trading access on Mughal terms.** - Incorrect. The grant is best understood as bounded commercial facility, not as equality of states.
- **C. They did not amount to territory or empire-wide monopoly.** - Incorrect. The absence of monopoly or territorial sovereignty is one of the key limits of the episode.
- **D. They granted the English a sovereign territorial state in India.** - Correct. Turning the farman into a territorial state is the classic teleological overstatement the topic warns against.

Examiner trap: A trading document was treated as if it had already created British India.

Workbook MCQ 13

Question: Why should the Sher Afghan romance story be handled carefully?

- A. Because Satish Chandra treats it as unproven later elaboration rather than secure evidence of Jahangir's prior design.
- B. Because the story is directly proven by Nur Jahan's coin legends.
- C. Because Sher Afghan never existed historically.
- D. Because the event belongs to Aurangzeb's reign, not Jahangir's.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Because Satish Chandra treats it as unproven later elaboration rather than secure evidence of Jahangir's prior design.** - Correct. The point is not that nothing happened in Bengal, but that romantic causation is not securely evidenced as the driver of events.
- **B. Because the story is directly proven by Nur Jahan's coin legends.** - Incorrect. Coin legends show Nur Jahan's later public authority, not a proven pre-marital conspiracy.
- **C. Because Sher Afghan never existed historically.** - Incorrect. Sher Afghan was a historical person; what is disputed is the dramatic retrospective narrative around him.
- **D. Because the event belongs to Aurangzeb's reign, not Jahangir's.** - Incorrect. The chronology belongs to Jahangir's period, not to a much later reign.

Examiner trap: Later romance was elevated into secure political causation.

Workbook MCQ 14

Question: Which evidence most directly establishes Nur Jahan's unusually public political authority?

- A. Later court gossip alone.
- B. Farmans in her name and coin legends associated with Badshah Begum.
- C. The assumption that every queen held identical powers.
- D. Shah Jahan's later throne ceremony.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Later court gossip alone.** - Incorrect. Gossip may preserve perceptions, but documentary and numismatic evidence is far stronger here.
- **B. Farmans in her name and coin legends associated with Badshah Begum.** - Correct. Farmans and coins are exactly the kind of formal evidence that makes Nur Jahan's authority historically demonstrable.
- **C. The assumption that every queen held identical powers.** - Incorrect. Her prominence is noteworthy precisely because all Mughal consorts did not enjoy identical documentary visibility.

- **D. Shah Jahan's later throne ceremony.** - Incorrect. Shah Jahan's later imperial symbolism belongs to a different reign and cannot prove Nur Jahan's status.

Examiner trap: The strongest documentary evidence was replaced by anecdote and generic assumptions about queenship.

Workbook MCQ 15

Question: What is the safest limit to place on Nur Jahan's farmans and coin legends?

- A. They prove she never exercised any real authority.
- B. They show only artistic taste, not politics.
- C. They prove public authority but not automatic monopoly over every imperial decision.
- D. They are modern nationalist fabrications.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. They prove she never exercised any real authority.** - Incorrect. The very reason the documents matter is that they do record real formal authority.
- **B. They show only artistic taste, not politics.** - Incorrect. Coinage and farmans speak directly to sovereignty-symbols and command, not merely to aesthetics.
- **C. They prove public authority but not automatic monopoly over every imperial decision.** - Correct. The documents justify strong claims about visibility and power while still stopping short of total sovereign replacement.
- **D. They are modern nationalist fabrications.** - Incorrect. These are early modern evidentiary forms, not later inventions.

Examiner trap: Good evidence of exceptional authority was pushed into an unwarranted theory of total control.

Workbook MCQ 16

Question: The Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb should be used primarily as evidence for

- A. the complete social history of Mughal women.
- B. the end of Jahangir's reign in Lahore.
- C. a fixed Nur Jahan-Khurram faction from 1611 onward.
- D. family memorial patronage and an architectural shift associated with Nur Jahan's circle.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. the complete social history of Mughal women.** - Incorrect. One dynastic monument cannot stand in for the social history of all Mughal women.
- **B. the end of Jahangir's reign in Lahore.** - Incorrect. Jahangir's burial at Lahore is a separate issue from this Agra-based family tomb.
- **C. a fixed Nur Jahan-Khurram faction from 1611 onward.** - Incorrect. Monumental patronage cannot by itself prove a stable court coalition over many years.
- **D. family memorial patronage and an architectural shift associated with Nur Jahan's circle.** - Correct. The tomb is best read through commemoration, patronage and the material culture of Nur Jahan's family network.

Examiner trap: A material monument was used to prove more political certainty than it can actually carry.

Workbook MCQ 17

Question: What does Beni Prasad's junta thesis argue in its strongest form?

- A. Nur Jahan, Itimad-ud-Daulah, Asaf Khan and Khurram formed a dominant court grouping.
- B. Jahangir's court had no household politics at all.
- C. Mahabat Khan founded the alliance after 1626.
- D. The Mewar settlement destroyed Rajput participation in empire.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Nur Jahan, Itimad-ud-Daulah, Asaf Khan and Khurram formed a dominant court grouping.** - Correct. That four-person configuration is the classic formulation of the fixed-junta thesis.
- **B. Jahangir's court had no household politics at all.** - Incorrect. Even critics of the thesis do not deny the importance of household politics.
- **C. Mahabat Khan founded the alliance after 1626.** - Incorrect. Mahabat Khan is not the founder of the alleged coalition; he is one of the later challengers to the court order.
- **D. The Mewar settlement destroyed Rajput participation in empire.** - Incorrect. The Mewar settlement belongs to Rajput accommodation, not to the definition of the junta thesis.

Examiner trap: The debated model itself was not stated accurately before it was criticised.

Workbook MCQ 18

Question: What is central to Nurul Hasan's critique of the fixed-junta model?

- A. Nur Jahan never issued farmans.
- B. Promotions and alliances remained wider and more fluid than the fixed-bloc model allows.
- C. Khurram never held a high mansab or military prestige.
- D. The *Jahangirnama* is a forged nineteenth-century text.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Nur Jahan never issued farmans.** - Incorrect. The critique does not deny her authority; it questions the monopoly model.
- **B. Promotions and alliances remained wider and more fluid than the fixed-bloc model allows.** - Correct. Wide distribution of favour and the lack of secure proof for a fixed long-term alliance are the heart of the argument.
- **C. Khurram never held a high mansab or military prestige.** - Incorrect. Khurram's real military prominence is one reason a simplistic patronage-only story fails.
- **D. The Jahangirnama is a forged nineteenth-century text.** - Incorrect. The memoir is a genuine early modern source, albeit one requiring criticism.

Examiner trap: Debate over monopoly was misread as denial of Nur Jahan's power itself.

Workbook MCQ 19

Question: Why is 1622 such a useful turning point in Topic 20?

- A. It is the year Jahangir acceded.
- B. It marks the beginning of Roe's embassy.
- C. It connects Qandahar, Jahangir's worsening health and sharper succession politics, making Nur Jahan's crisis role more overt.
- D. It is the year Mahabat Khan first seized the emperor.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. It is the year Jahangir acceded.** - Incorrect. Jahangir acceded in 1605, not 1622.
- **B. It marks the beginning of Roe's embassy.** - Incorrect. Roe began in 1615; 1622 matters for a different conjuncture.
- **C. It connects Qandahar, Jahangir's worsening health and sharper succession politics, making Nur Jahan's crisis role more overt.** - Correct. After 1622, external shock, court health anxieties and succession conflict made court alignments visibly sharper.
- **D. It is the year Mahabat Khan first seized the emperor.** - Incorrect. Mahabat Khan's coup belongs to 1626, though it is part of the same later-crisis environment.

Examiner trap: The date 1622 was remembered only for Qandahar and detached from internal court consequences.

Workbook MCQ 20

Question: Why did Shahryar become more politically significant in the later Jahangir years?

- A. He conquered the Deccan independently of the empire.
- B. He wrote the full *Jahangirnama* himself.
- C. He became governor of Bengal under Islam Khan in 1608.
- D. His connection to Ladli Begum sharpened succession calculations around Nur Jahan's household strategy.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. He conquered the Deccan independently of the empire.** - Incorrect. Shahryar's importance here is dynastic and factional, not independent military conquest.
- **B. He wrote the full Jahangirnama himself.** - Incorrect. The *Jahangirnama* is Jahangir's memoir with later continuation layers, not Shahryar's authorship project.
- **C. He became governor of Bengal under Islam Khan in 1608.** - Incorrect. That office belongs to Islam Khan's Bengal reorganisation, not to Shahryar.
- **D. His connection to Ladli Begum sharpened succession calculations around Nur Jahan's household strategy.** - Correct. The marriage link tied him more closely to Nur Jahan's household calculations and therefore to the succession contest.

Examiner trap: Shahryar's later-role significance was replaced by unrelated administrative or literary claims.

Workbook MCQ 21

Question: Which combination best explains Khurram's rebellion?

- A. princely prestige, succession anxiety, command dispute and resource bargaining.
- B. only Portuguese hostility at sea.
- C. only a doctrinal religious disagreement with Jahangir.
- D. only a private insult by Mahabat Khan.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. princely prestige, succession anxiety, command dispute and resource bargaining.** - Correct. Khurram's rebellion came from the intersection of his strength, his fears, the Qandahar emergency and competition over resources and court access.
- **B. only Portuguese hostility at sea.** - Incorrect. Maritime rivalry had little to do with the inner logic of Khurram's revolt.
- **C. only a doctrinal religious disagreement with Jahangir.** - Incorrect. The rebellion was not driven by a doctrinal theological split.
- **D. only a private insult by Mahabat Khan.** - Incorrect. Mahabat Khan was important later, but Khurram's crisis cannot be reduced to a private quarrel with him.

Examiner trap: A multi-causal princely rebellion was squeezed into one neat cause.

Workbook MCQ 22

Question: What is historically important about Khurram's eventual submission?

- A. It immediately made him emperor.
- B. It included the hostage dispatch of Dara and Aurangzeb and showed negotiated reintegration after rebellion.
- C. It proves the Mughals had no ability to punish princes.
- D. It took place before the fall of Qandahar.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. It immediately made him emperor.** - Incorrect. Submission restored him to a negotiated position; it did not yet make him ruler.
- **B. It included the hostage dispatch of Dara and Aurangzeb and showed negotiated reintegration after rebellion.** - Correct. The hostage element reveals how princely reintegration after rebellion still required concrete guarantees.
- **C. It proves the Mughals had no ability to punish princes.** - Incorrect. The empire punished, defeated and bargained with princes; lack of any coercive capacity is not the lesson.
- **D. It took place before the fall of Qandahar.** - Incorrect. The submission followed the post-1622 crisis and therefore came after the Qandahar setback had already sharpened tensions.

Examiner trap: The settlement phase of the rebellion was forgotten, leaving only the dramatic outbreak.

Workbook MCQ 23

Question: How should the 1622 loss of Qandahar be used inside Topic 20?

- A. As the whole subject of the chapter, replacing court politics.
- B. As proof that Jahangir never governed at all.
- C. As a bounded external trigger that intensified Khurram's court and command calculations.
- D. As the event that ended English trade in Gujarat.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. As the whole subject of the chapter, replacing court politics.** - Incorrect. Topic 19 owns the full foreign-policy system; Topic 20 uses Qandahar only for its impact on internal politics.
- **B. As proof that Jahangir never governed at all.** - Incorrect. One frontier loss does not erase the wider record of governance, consolidation and court management.
- **C. As a bounded external trigger that intensified Khurram's court and command calculations.** - Correct. Here Qandahar matters because it sharpened the succession-command-resource crisis around Khurram.
- **D. As the event that ended English trade in Gujarat.** - Incorrect. Gujarat trade and English diplomacy followed a different logic from the Safavid seizure of Qandahar.

Examiner trap: A boundary-trigger event was allowed to swallow the neighbouring topic's full ownership.

Workbook MCQ 24

Question: Which grievance cluster helps explain Mahabat Khan's coup?

- A. pressure over accounts, elephants, transfer and fear of reprisal at court.
- B. demand for Portuguese naval command.
- C. a campaign to annex Mewar permanently in 1615.
- D. disagreement over the anti-Jain order in Gujarat.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. pressure over accounts, elephants, transfer and fear of reprisal at court.** - Correct. The coup emerged from court pressure on a powerful commander who felt vulnerable after service against Khurram.
- **B. demand for Portuguese naval command.** - Incorrect. Maritime command against the Portuguese has nothing to do with Mahabat's grievance structure.
- **C. a campaign to annex Mewar permanently in 1615.** - Incorrect. The Mewar settlement preceded the coup by more than a decade and is unrelated as a grievance cluster.
- **D. disagreement over the anti-Jain order in Gujarat.** - Incorrect. Religious policy episodes do not explain Mahabat Khan's personal court crisis.

Examiner trap: A commander's court grievance was blurred with unrelated frontier or religious episodes.

Workbook MCQ 25

Question: What is the key structural lesson of the Jhelum coup?

- A. Possessing the emperor's body gave immediate leverage but not durable control over the empire.
- B. A Rajput contingent automatically conferred universal legitimacy.
- C. The Mughal treasury and bureaucracy ceased to matter once the emperor was seized.
- D. Nur Jahan surrendered permanently after the first failed response.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. Possessing the emperor's body gave immediate leverage but not durable control over the empire.** - Correct. The coup worked instantly because kingship was embodied, yet it failed durably because coalition, finance and bureaucracy mattered too.
- **B. A Rajput contingent automatically conferred universal legitimacy.** - Incorrect. Rajput force could give coercive muscle, but legitimacy still required a much broader settlement.
- **C. The Mughal treasury and bureaucracy ceased to matter once the emperor was seized.** - Incorrect. The failure of the coup proves that administrative and fiscal structures still mattered enormously.
- **D. Nur Jahan surrendered permanently after the first failed response.** - Incorrect. Nur Jahan shifted strategy and remained active in the reversal of the crisis.

Examiner trap: Short-term shock was misread as if it had erased the empire's deeper institutional supports.

Workbook MCQ 26

Question: Nur Jahan's role in the aftermath of Mahabat Khan's coup is best described as

- A. purely ceremonial presence without political initiative.
- B. initial military resistance followed by strategic entry into the captive camp and political manoeuvre.
- C. complete disappearance from events after 1622.
- D. proof that she had already become emperor in law.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. purely ceremonial presence without political initiative.** - Incorrect. Her behaviour after the first failed armed response is important precisely because it was tactical and political.
- **B. initial military resistance followed by strategic entry into the captive camp and political manoeuvre.** - Correct. She first tried force, then changed method and worked from within the captive situation to weaken Mahabat's support.
- **C. complete disappearance from events after 1622.** - Incorrect. The later reign makes her more, not less, visible in crisis politics.
- **D. proof that she had already become emperor in law.** - Incorrect. Political effectiveness in a coup does not amount to constitutional enthronement.

Examiner trap: Effective crisis manoeuvre was exaggerated into formal sovereign replacement.

Workbook MCQ 27

Question: Which statement about Jahangir's ruling class is most accurate?

- A. He dismantled Akbar's composite nobility and ruled only through one clan.
- B. Rajputs vanished from high service after 1605.
- C. He broadly retained composite nobility, including Rajputs, Afghans and early Maratha sardars within the mansab-jagir order.
- D. The mansab-jagir framework ended when Nur Jahan gained influence.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. He dismantled Akbar's composite nobility and ruled only through one clan.** - Incorrect. Household influence increased, but the wider composite nobility was not dismantled into a single-clan order.
- **B. Rajputs vanished from high service after 1605.** - Incorrect. Rajput participation remained important beyond the Kachhwahas as well.
- **C. He broadly retained composite nobility, including Rajputs, Afghans and early Maratha sardars within the mansab-jagir order.** - Correct. Continuity of composite elite structure is one of the basic owner's most important corrective points.
- **D. The mansab-jagir framework ended when Nur Jahan gained influence.** - Incorrect. The institutional framework survived; Topic 21 deals with later modifications under Shah Jahan.

Examiner trap: Court access politics were mistaken for the disappearance of the wider composite nobility.

Workbook MCQ 28

Question: Which verdict best fits Jahangir's religious policy?

- A. a simple restoration of jizya and uniform exclusion.
- B. perfect tolerance untouched by any coercive act.
- C. chaotic irreligion with no recognisable policy patterns.
- D. broad continuity with Akbar's accommodation, complicated by specific coercive and symbolic assertions of Islamic kingship.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. a simple restoration of jizya and uniform exclusion.** - Incorrect. Jahangir did not restore jizya and cannot be reduced to a uniform exclusionary policy.
- **B. perfect tolerance untouched by any coercive act.** - Incorrect. Guru Arjan, Mewar/Kangra coercion and other episodes make a spotless-tolerance portrait indefensible.
- **C. chaotic irreligion with no recognisable policy patterns.** - Incorrect. There were patterns of rule and symbolic action even though they were not ideologically uniform.
- **D. broad continuity with Akbar's accommodation, complicated by specific coercive and symbolic assertions of Islamic kingship.** - Correct. This answer preserves the composite framework and the real coercive exceptions in one sentence.

Examiner trap: One vivid episode was allowed to swallow the broader pattern, or the broader pattern was used to erase the episode.

Workbook MCQ 29

Question: Why is Jadrup worth remembering in a Jahangir answer?

- A. He helps show Jahangir's engagement with non-Muslim intellectual and spiritual figures.
- B. He commanded the English fleet at Swally.
- C. He designed the Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb.
- D. He led the Mahabat Khan coup.

Correct answer: A

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. He helps show Jahangir's engagement with non-Muslim intellectual and spiritual figures.** - Correct. Jadrup is a concise named example for Jahangir's interest in interaction beyond narrowly sectarian limits.
- **B. He commanded the English fleet at Swally.** - Incorrect. Swally concerns English and Portuguese maritime conflict, not Jadrup.
- **C. He designed the Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb.** - Incorrect. The tomb is linked to Nur Jahan's family patronage, not to Jadrup's design role.
- **D. He led the Mahabat Khan coup.** - Incorrect. Jadrup was a Vedantic interlocutor, not a military actor in 1626.

Examiner trap: A small but high-yield name for religious accommodation was lost because students remembered only the coercive episodes.

Workbook MCQ 30

Question: Why is Ustad Mansur relevant in Topic 20?

- A. He led the Mughal siege of Kangra.
- B. He stands for Jahangir's courtly naturalism and precise visual observation of flora and fauna.
- C. He authored the *Iqbalnama*.
- D. He negotiated the 1615 Mewar compact.

Correct answer: B

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. He led the Mughal siege of Kangra.** - Incorrect. Kangra was a military and political success, not an artistic campaign under Ustad Mansur.
- **B. He stands for Jahangir's courtly naturalism and precise visual observation of flora and fauna.** - Correct. Mansur is the most portable named example for Jahangir's connoisseurship and natural-history culture.
- **C. He authored the Iqbalnama.** - Incorrect. The *Iqbalnama* is associated with Mutamad Khan, not with the imperial painter Mansur.
- **D. He negotiated the 1615 Mewar compact.** - Incorrect. Mewar's settlement was political-military, not an artistic negotiation by Mansur.

Examiner trap: Cultural evidence was left out, making Jahangir appear only as a faction-ridden ruler.

Workbook MCQ 31

Question: What does "continuation" or "redaction" in relation to the *Jahangirnama* warn the historian against?

- A. assuming the memoir is valueless because later hands existed.
- B. assuming later hands and authorship layers do not matter at all.
- C. ignoring questions of who wrote which portion and what that means for self-representation.
- D. using the text for chronology under any circumstances.

Correct answer: C

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. assuming the memoir is valueless because later hands existed.** - Incorrect. Later continuation does not destroy the source; it changes the way the source has to be handled.
- **B. assuming later hands and authorship layers do not matter at all.** - Incorrect. Authorship layers matter precisely because the memoir is so central to the reign.
- **C. ignoring questions of who wrote which portion and what that means for self-representation.** - Correct. Periodising authorship helps distinguish Jahangir's own voice from later continuation and therefore sharpens source criticism.
- **D. using the text for chronology under any circumstances.** - Incorrect. The text remains highly useful for chronology and court language when used critically.

Examiner trap: Source criticism was reduced to either total trust or total dismissal instead of authorship-aware use.

Workbook MCQ 32

Question: Which overall verdict best matches the full Topic 20 evidence?

- A. The reign was only a romance chapter before Shah Jahan.
- B. Nur Jahan's evidence proves the whole empire was permanently monopolised by one camp from 1611 onward.
- C. The empire had already entered terminal collapse in 1605.
- D. Jahangir remained a governing emperor whose reign combined negotiated consolidation, exceptional female authority and later structural strain without proven institutional collapse.

Correct answer: D

Option-wise explanations:

- **A. The reign was only a romance chapter before Shah Jahan.** - Incorrect. The reign contains major questions of accession, frontier settlement, princely rebellion, court structure and source method that go far beyond romance.
- **B. Nur Jahan's evidence proves the whole empire was permanently monopolised by one camp from 1611 onward.** - Incorrect. Family concentration and Nur Jahan's authority were real, but the evidence does not prove one permanent monopolistic camp.
- **C. The empire had already entered terminal collapse in 1605.** - Incorrect. Mewar, Bengal, Kangra, composite nobility and cultural vitality all argue against terminal collapse from accession.
- **D. Jahangir remained a governing emperor whose reign combined negotiated consolidation, exceptional female authority and later structural strain without proven institutional collapse.** - Correct. This verdict preserves the central strengths, the distinctive role of Nur Jahan and the undeniable later strains in one balanced formulation.

Examiner trap: A vivid fragment of the reign was mistaken for the whole analytical verdict.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Part II - Verified direct and routed PYQs

Local 2018-2026 ledger and OCR verification returned **no direct or adjacent Topic 20 PYQ** that could be retained honestly without creating owner overlap or fabricated wording. The workbook therefore records the verified absence and keeps the solved section transparent.

Part III - Six original mains models (locked count)

Original Mains 1 - 10 marks (150 words)

Question: Why should Jahangir's accession be described as a political settlement rather than a routine hereditary transfer?

Model answer: Jahangir's accession in 1605 was dynastic, but not merely automatic. Prince Salim had already damaged trust through his Allahabad autonomy, coinage and association with Abu'l Fazl's killing. Hence succession needed noble recognition, redistribution of offices and a public language of justice before it could look settled.

The *Jahangirnama*'s early regulations and the chain of justice are important in this context. They projected a ruler who was accessible, corrective and morally purposeful. That image helped convert contested princely succession into acceptable kingship. At the same time, Jahangir did not destroy Akbar's wider elite structure. He kept the revenue-military machine and much of the composite nobility functioning.

Therefore, accession was best understood as a bargain: dynastic claim plus elite recognition plus public justice language. It was more than routine inheritance, but less than a free election by nobles.

Demand decoding: "Why should ... be described" asks for reasons supporting a specific interpretation, not a general biography of Salim or a later-reign narrative.

Executable answer/elimination plan: Open with the dynastic-but-not-automatic contrast; use Allahabad and Abu'l Fazl as evidence of damaged trust; add orders and chain of justice as public legitimation; close with the accession bargain formula.

Why this earns marks / route earns marks: This answer earns marks because it turns "accession" into an explanatory process by naming Allahabad, Abu'l Fazl, noble recognition and justice language rather than offering a bare date.

How to improve/strengthen: A stronger version could name one trusted associate promoted at accession, such as Shaikh Farid Bukhari, to make the noble-settlement point even sharper.

Original Mains 2 - 10 marks (150 words)

Question: How should the 1615 Mewar settlement be used to explain Mughal consolidation under Jahangir?

Model answer: The 1615 Mewar settlement is one of the clearest examples of Mughal consolidation through unequal accommodation. Jahangir and Prince Khurram applied enough pressure to make resistance costly, but the final terms allowed Sisodia honour to survive publicly. Rana Amar Singh was not compelled to attend court in person, while Karan Singh was received with honour and service.

This matters because Mughal power did not always seek annexation. By preserving the ruling house yet securing suzerainty, the empire turned a chronic frontier into a more manageable political relationship. The arrangement therefore demonstrates that conciliation could be a technology of consolidation when outright humiliation might have kept resistance alive.

However, the settlement should not be romanticised as equality. Mewar accepted Mughal superiority. Its significance lies in the combination of hierarchy and honour, not in either one alone.

Demand decoding: The directive asks how the settlement explains consolidation, so the answer must connect terms to political effect rather than list them mechanically.

Executable answer/elimination plan: Define the settlement as unequal accommodation; insert Amar Singh/Karan Singh evidence; explain why honour made submission durable; conclude by rejecting both equality and annexation.

Why this earns marks / route earns marks: This answer earns marks because it explains the mechanism of consolidation through named terms - Rana Amar Singh, Karan Singh, suzerainty and honour - instead of narrating Mewar as a generic Rajput story.

How to improve/strengthen: You could add Jahangir's Ajmer position and Khurram's military role in one compact clause to make the coercive backdrop more visible.

Original Mains 3 - 15 marks (250 words)

Question: "The Guru Arjan episode of 1606 must be read through political suspicion and source conflict rather than communal shorthand." Discuss.

Model answer: The Guru Arjan episode of 1606 cannot be handled responsibly through a single slogan. It emerged immediately after Khusrau's revolt, when the new emperor was acutely suspicious of any support network around a rival prince. Jahangir's own memoir represents Guru Arjan as a revered leader with a wide following and accuses him of assisting or blessing Khusrau. That political context is indispensable.

At the same time, Jahangir's language is not politically neutral. The memoir contains a sharper religious register than a purely administrative note would require. Sikh traditions and other testimony preserve the memory of martyrdom, coercion and punitive intent in forms that cannot be waved away. Satish Chandra also notes disagreement over whether the decisive action was direct execution or a crushing fine whose enforcement caused death.

Therefore, the event must be read through layered evidence: princely rebellion, imperial suspicion, punitive action and the making of Sikh historical memory. Such a reading avoids two errors. The first is to reduce the episode to neutral statecraft with no religious edge. The second is to remove it entirely from the 1606 crisis and recast it as a timeless communal conflict.

The historical significance is large because the episode became a turning point in Mughal-Sikh relations. Yet that larger trajectory belongs to a longer chronology reaching beyond Jahangir's immediate political crisis.

Demand decoding: "Discuss" here requires weighing the sufficiency of political suspicion and source conflict against simpler communal or administrative labels.

Executable answer/elimination plan: Open with the anti-shorthand thesis; one paragraph on Khusrau and Jahangir's accusation; one on Sikh memory and source disagreement; one on why layered causation is superior; close with the turning-point qualification.

Why this earns marks / route earns marks: This answer earns marks because it names Khusrau, Jahangir's memoir, Sikh memory and the fine-versus-execution debate, then explains why each evidentiary strand matters to interpretation.

How to improve/strengthen: A sharper version could add one explicit line that later militarisation under Guru Hargobind should not be projected backward unchanged into 1606.

Original Mains 4 - 15 marks (250 words)

Question: Assess Nur Jahan's authority as a documented political power within the Mughal court.

Model answer: Nur Jahan should be treated as a documented political actor of exceptional importance in Jahangir's reign. She was not merely a romantic figure or a decorative consort. After her 1611 marriage to Jahangir, she occupied a position in which household command, petitionary access, patronage and kinship could all acquire political weight.

The strongest evidence is formal. Farmans issued in her name and coin legends associated with Badshah Begum language give her authority an unusually public and material visibility. Such evidence is stronger than court gossip because it links her directly to documentary and symbolic forms of sovereignty. Her father Itimad-ud-Daulah and brother Asaf Khan also occupied major positions, while the Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb preserves the patronage side of her influence in durable material form.

Yet her power should not be overstated into a fiction that she ruled the empire alone. Jahangir remained emperor, promotions were not all monopolised by a single bloc, and Mughal politics still depended on a wider noble field. The later intensification of her role after 1622 is especially important: Qandahar, Jahangir's health, Khurram's rebellion and Mahabat Khan's challenge made her intervention more overt.

Thus Nur Jahan's authority was real, exceptional and documentable, but it operated within Jahangirian sovereignty and a patriarchal imperial order rather than outside them.

Demand decoding: "Assess" requires a measured judgement: neither denial of power nor exaggerated sovereign replacement is enough.

Executable answer/elimination plan: Define Nur Jahan as a documented actor; use farmans/coins first, then family and patronage evidence; periodise the stronger post-1622 phase; conclude with bounded but exceptional authority.

Why this earns marks / route earns marks: This answer earns marks because it grounds authority in farmans, coin legends, kinship offices and patronage, then explicitly qualifies the temptation to convert those facts into a total-rule claim.

How to improve/strengthen: Add one concise gender sentence - exceptional female authority inside a patriarchal court - if space permits, because it sharpens the interpretive frame without drifting into theory-heavy prose.

Original Mains 5 - 20 marks (250 words)

Question: Examine the causes and significance of Khurram's rebellion during Jahangir's reign.

Model answer: Khurram's rebellion was not an impulsive act by an offended prince; it was a major succession crisis produced by military success, resource politics and the unstable conjunction created after 1622. By the early 1620s Khurram had become the strongest princely contender. His Mewar and Deccan record, high mansab, title "Shah Jahan," and control advantages such as Hisar-Firuza all strengthened his claim.

The immediate turning point was the Safavid capture of Qandahar in 1622. Khurram feared that commanding a difficult frontier campaign away from court might expose him to rivals. Hence he sought guarantees over command, family security, troops and jagirs. These anxieties sharpened further because Shahryar's position rose through his connection with Ladli Begum, making succession appear less predictable.

The rebellion then moved through defeat, regrouping and shifting theatres, including eastern India and the Deccan, before eventual submission. This sequence shows that Mughal princes commanded serious military and regional resources of their own. The crisis distracted the empire for years, weakened coordination over Qandahar and enabled Deccani recovery.

Its significance lies in what it reveals about the Mughal polity. Under Jahangir, imperial structure remained strong enough to defeat and reintegrate a rebel prince, but succession remained perilously tied to access, command and resource bargaining. Khurram's revolt therefore illuminates the political economy of dynastic monarchy more clearly than any one-cause personal explanation can.

Demand decoding: "Examine causes and significance" requires both the trigger-matrix and the larger implications for Mughal political structure.

Executable answer/elimination plan: Use one opening sentence on Khurram's strength; one body block on 1622 command/resource anxieties; one on campaign course and submission; one on significance for succession and imperial capacity; conclude with the dynastic-monarchy verdict.

Why this earns marks / route earns marks: This answer earns marks because it links princely prestige, Qandahar, jagirs, Shahryar and the later imperial distraction into one coherent causal and analytical chain.

How to improve/strengthen: A stronger version could add Bilochpur and the hostage dispatch of Dara and Aurangzeb as named evidence to sharpen the rebellion's sequence.

Original Mains 6 - 20 marks (250 words)

Question: Did factional politics overwhelm Mughal sovereignty in the later Jahangir period? Discuss with reference to Nur Jahan, Mahabat Khan and the source problem.

Model answer: Factional politics became sharper in Jahangir's later years, but they did not wholly overwhelm Mughal sovereignty. The most careful reading begins by rejecting two simplifications: that Nur Jahan exercised no serious political power, and that she replaced Jahangir as sole ruler. Evidence such as farmans, coin legends and post-1622 crisis action proves her exceptional authority, especially once Jahangir's health declined and succession rivalries intensified.

Yet later court politics were not reducible to a single permanent camp. The fixed "Nur Jahan junta" thesis associated with Beni Prasad has been qualified by historians such as Nurul Hasan and Satish Chandra, who show that promotions and alignments remained wider and more fluid. Real family concentration existed, but the whole nobility was not frozen into two blocks.

Mahabat Khan's coup of 1626 then reveals the limits of both faction and imperial personhood. By seizing Jahangir near the Jhelum, Mahabat demonstrated how much immediate power flowed from custody of the emperor's body. But he could not convert that seizure into durable control over treasury, administration and the wider nobility. Nur Jahan's manoeuvres helped reverse the situation, showing her political capability without proving sovereign replacement.

The source problem is central. The *Jahangirnama*, later chronicles, European observers, coins and farmans all illuminate the reign, but each reflects its own genre and angle. Therefore the strongest conclusion is graded: factional politics deeply strained the later reign, yet Mughal sovereignty remained operative enough to outlast both rebellion and coup.

Demand decoding: The question asks "Did factional politics overwhelm ... ?" so the answer must weigh the extent of strain and stop short of an all-or-nothing conclusion.

Executable answer/elimination plan: Define the problem through Nur Jahan first; test the junta thesis; use Mahabat as the structural case-study; insert one sentence on source limits; conclude with strain without collapse.

Why this earns marks / route earns marks: This answer earns marks because it connects historiography, documentary evidence and the Mahabat episode to a single verdict about the resilience and strain of Jahangirian sovereignty.

How to improve/strengthen: If more space were available, add one line on composite nobility and the continued functioning of frontier policy to reinforce why sovereignty was strained rather than extinguished.